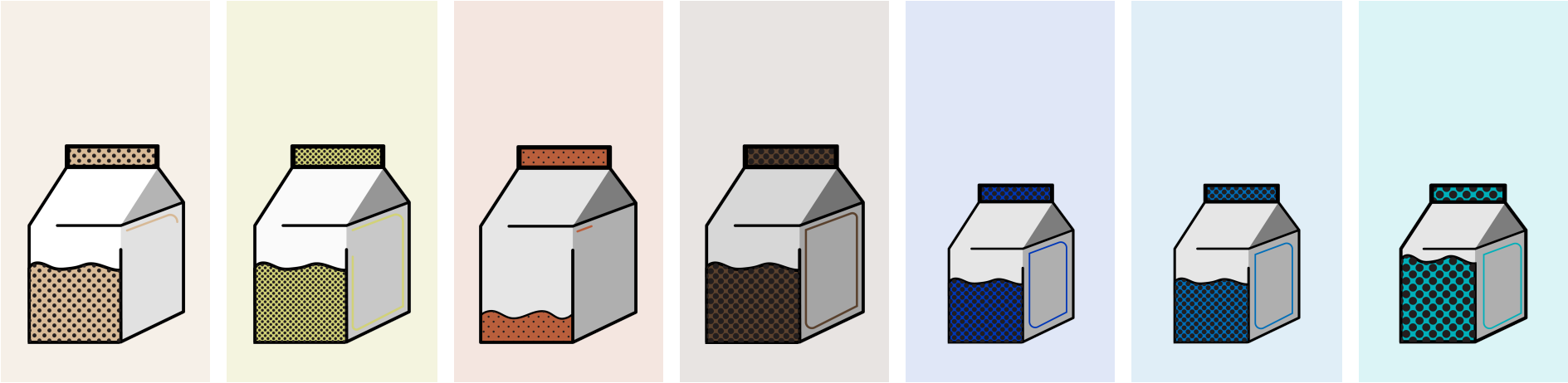
Visual Codes for Milk

Judge a milk by its carton.



Every milk looks the same until you read the fine print. So I moved the fine print onto the carton.

CHALLENGE

Four variables, one small package.

APPROACH

One visual channel per variable.

4

variables

4

visual channels

7

cartons

DESIGNER

Dylan Riegert

COURSE

Graphic Systems, Spring 2026

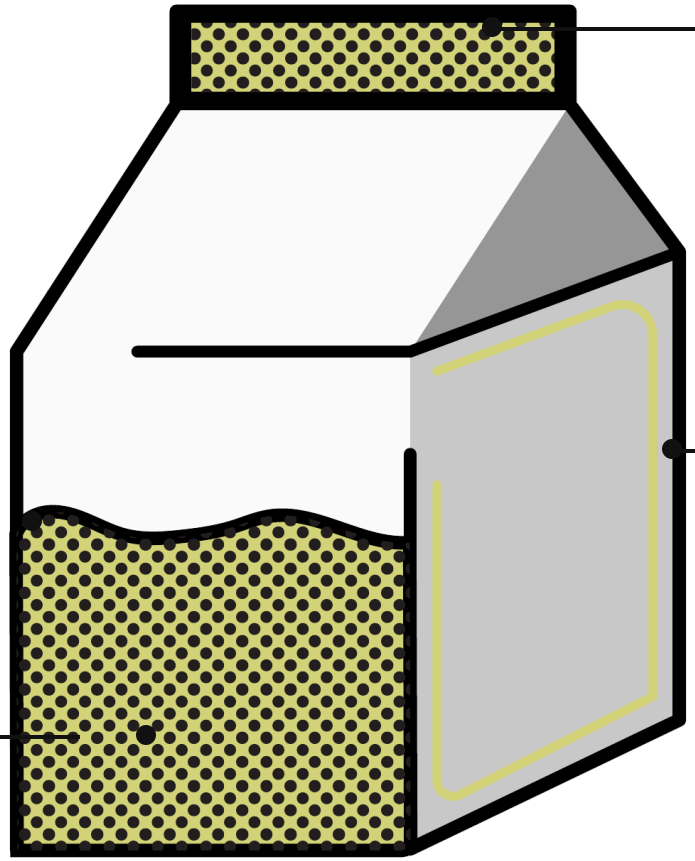
DISCIPLINE

Information design, packaging

OUTPUT

4-part code system, 7 cartons

One carton, four signals.



Cap = quick read
Same code, seen from above.

Ring = protein
Closed ring, 8 g.

Fill = calories
Fuller means more.

Color + dots = type + fat
Bigger dots, more fat.

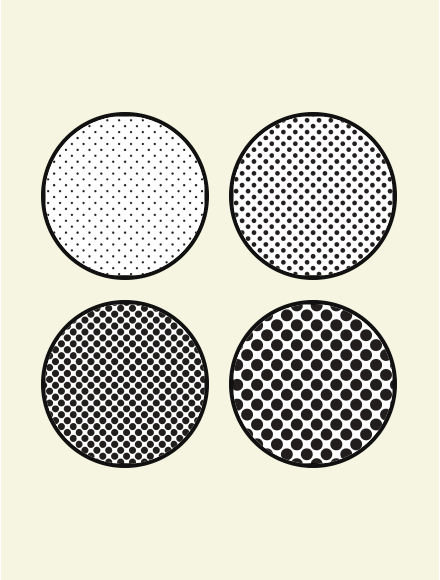
The key.



01 TYPE

Color

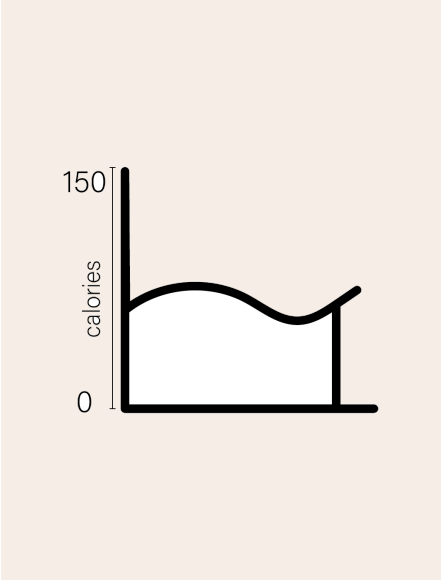
Every base gets its own hue.



02 FAT

Halftone

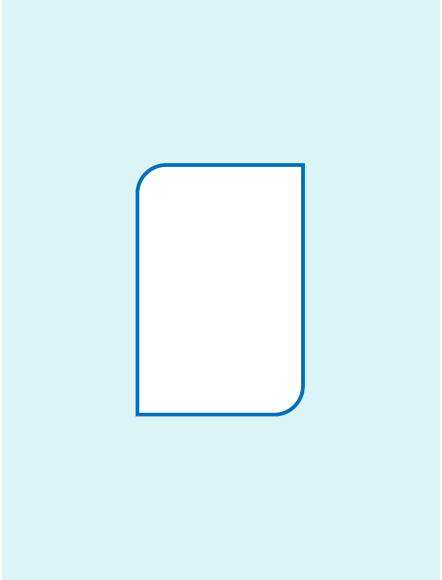
Bigger dots, more fat.



03 CALORIES

Fill level

Fuller carton, more calories.



04 PROTEIN

Ring

Closed ring, 8 g.

Plant-based

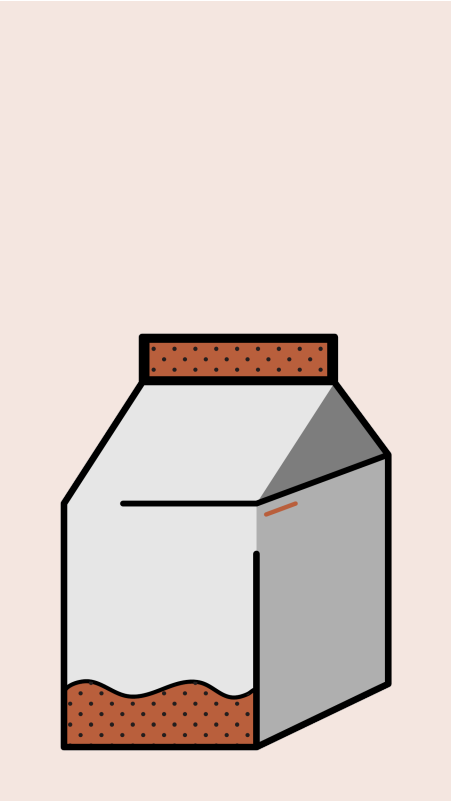
Almond runs light. Coconut runs rich.



Oat



Soy



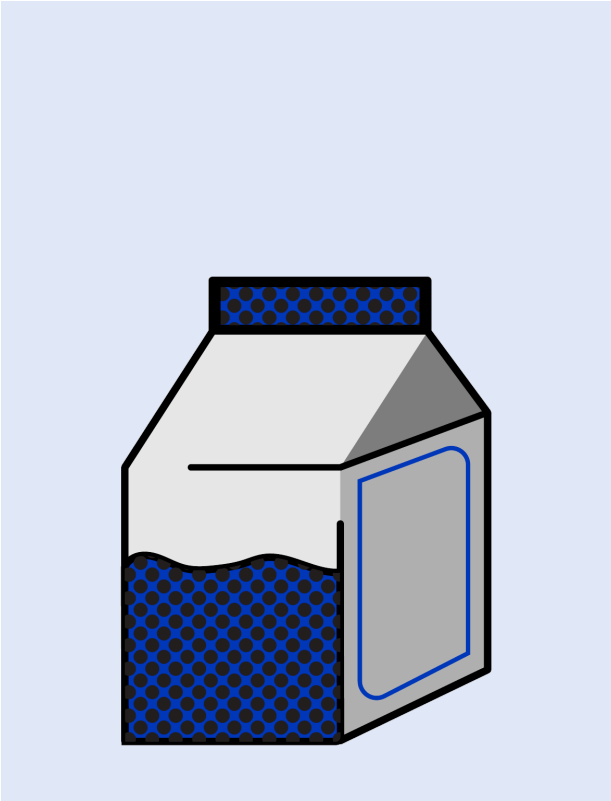
Almond



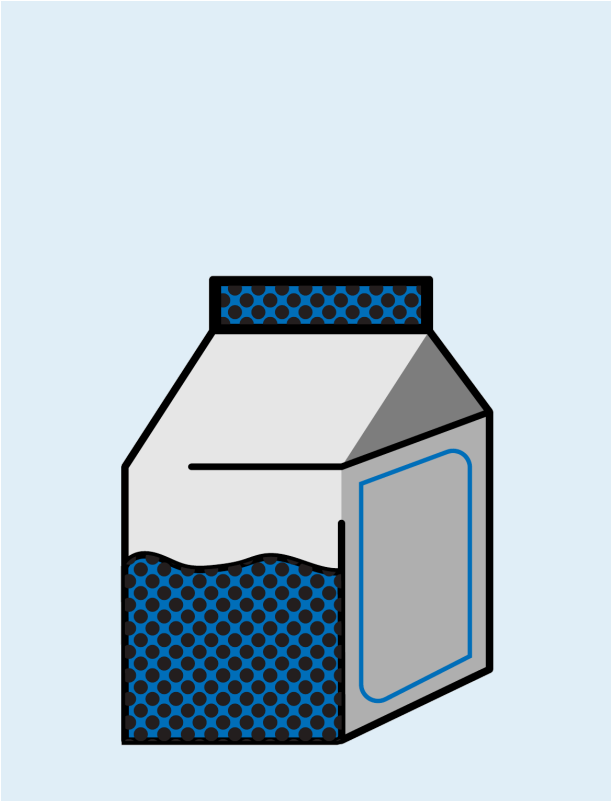
Coconut

Dairy

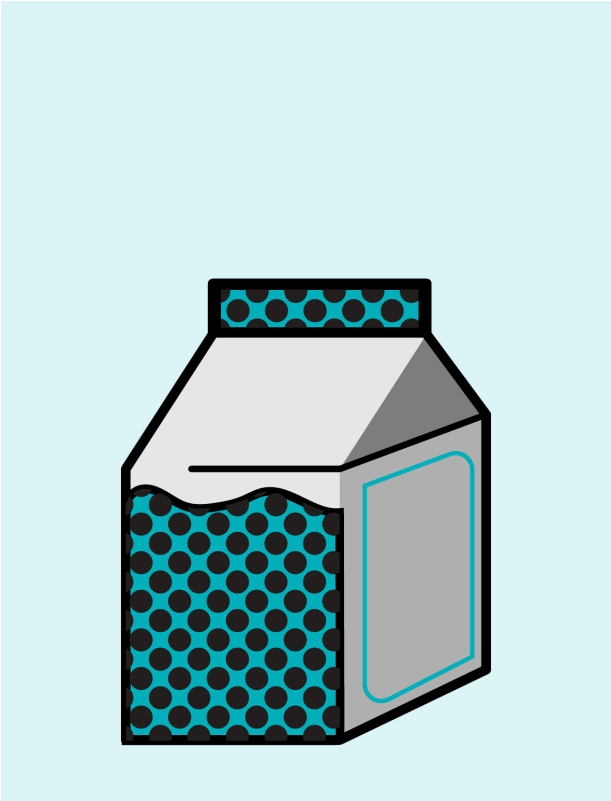
One blue family, three shades.



- Whole



- 2% reduced



- 2%

Read in seconds, not studied.

01

Texture, not just color

Fat still reads in grayscale.

02

A fixed silhouette

Only the data changes.

03

Familiar metaphors

Fuller means more. Closed means complete.

NEXT Test with shoppers, then design an in-store shelf key.